

Contents

- 8 **FOREWORD** by Carol Vorderman
- 10 **HOW THIS BOOK WORKS**

1 WHAT IS CODING?

- 14 What is a computer program?
- 16 Thinking like a computer
- 18 Becoming a coder

2 STARTING FROM SCRATCH

- 22 What is Scratch?
- 24 Installing Scratch
- 26 Scratch interface
- 28 Sprites
- 30 Colored blocks and scripts
- 32 **Project 1: Escape the dragon!**
- 38 Making things move
- 40 Costumes
- 42 Hide and seek
- 44 Events
- 46 Simple loops
- 48 Pens and turtles
- 50 Variables
- 52 Math
- 54 Strings and lists
- 56 Coordinates
- 58 Make some noise
- 60 **Project 2: Roll the dice**
- 62 True or false?

- 64 Decisions and branches
- 66 Sensing and detecting
- 68 Complex loops
- 70 Sending messages
- 72 Creating blocks
- 74 **Project 3: Monkey mayhem**
- 82 Time to experiment

3 PLAYING WITH PYTHON

- 86 What is Python?
- 88 Installing Python
- 92 Introducing IDLE
- 94 Errors
- 96 **Project 4: Ghost game**
- 98 Ghost game decoded
- 100 Program flow
- 102 Simple commands
- 104 Harder commands
- 106 Which window?
- 108 Variables in Python
- 110 Types of data
- 112 Math in Python
- 114 Strings in Python
- 116 Input and output
- 118 Making decisions
- 120 Branching